



Formal and semi-formal writing

Component 1 • Exercise 6 • 15 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

Learning focus

Write 120–160 words as an article, report, essay or review with purposeful structure and appropriate register.

Match form, reader and purpose

For an article, use a clear opening and engaging but controlled voice; for a report, describe findings and make a recommendation; for an essay, develop a position; for a review, assess an experience with examples. Follow the form specified in the rubric. Marks: content 6, language 9.

Worked example

A report for a principal should say what students used, what difficulties arose and what action would help. “Hi!” and “Awesome!” would not suit that audience.

Develop a balanced paragraph

Explain each idea using a reason or example instead of listing points. Use transitions to guide the reader; contrast a benefit with a realistic limit, then make a practical recommendation. Check subject-verb agreement and tenses.

Worked example

“The new tables provide a quiet place to work. However, they are often full at lunchtime. A booking system could make access fairer.”



Practice paper

Formal and semi-formal writing

Original FagusED practice. Answer on the lines provided. The number of marks is shown in square brackets.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Your school has opened a new study room. The principal asks you to write a short report on its first month. Include: what students find useful; one problem students have experienced; what the school could improve. Write 120–160 words.

[15] Content: 6; Language: 9.

Worked response

The sample below addresses all three prompts and models a suitable register. Other well developed responses may also earn credit.

Report on the new study room. The room has been open for one month, and students say that the quiet tables make it easier to finish homework before travelling home. The charging points are particularly useful for those who use a laptop in lessons. Several students also appreciate being able to ask a member of staff for help. However, the room is frequently full at lunchtime. Some pupils leave without finding a seat, while others put their bags on empty chairs to reserve them. I recommend introducing a simple sign-in system during the busiest period and asking students to keep bags under their tables. The school could also display the current opening times more clearly near the entrance. These changes would make the room more accessible without requiring major new equipment. Overall, students value the space, and small adjustments should help more of them use it effectively.

Marking focus

Content [6]: cover all three prompts and develop relevant ideas. Language [9]: range and accuracy of grammar and vocabulary, organisation and appropriate register. Verify 120–160 words and edit punctuation and spelling.

Assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language (Count-in Speaking) 0511 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/721343-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages, prompts and scripts by FagusED. June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user informed presentation. Independent practice material, not an official Cambridge paper.